

UNIT 08

SPEAK GENTLY (POEM)

WORDS AND MEANING

S. #	Words	Meaning in English	Meaning in Urdu
1.	Accents	Distinctive ways of pronouncing words or phrases	الہجہ
2.	Anonymous	Unknown or unnamed	نامعلوم
3.	Careworn	Showing signs of worry or stress; tired-looking	پریشان
4.	Eternity	Infinite or unending time	ابدیت
5.	Gently	In a kind and mild manner; softly	نرمی سے
6.	To Grieve	To feel deep sorrow or sadness	رنجیدہ ہونا
7.	Harsh	Rough or severe in manner or appearance	سخت
8.	To Mar	To damage or spoil the quality or appearance of	خراب کرنا
9.	Nearly	Almost; not quite	تقریباً
10.	Achieve	To accomplish or attain	حاصل کرنا
11.	Whose sand of life is nearly run	Referring to someone whose life is coming to an end	جس کی زندگی کا وقت تقریباً ختم ہو رہا ہے

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Q1: Who authored this poem? What is the poem's theme?

Ans: The poem was composed by an anonymous poet. It imparts a timeless message centered on a valuable life virtue. The poet emphasizes that using carefully chosen words spoken in a kind and gentle manner leaves a strong impact, garners respect, and demonstrates love. Sweet and soft words can win the hearts of others.

Q2: What are the consequences of adopting a harsh attitude?

Ans: Speaking harshly is a moral and social transgression that can negate our good deeds. It's important to cultivate gentleness in our character. This approach safeguards the positive actions we've undertaken during our time in this mortal world.

Q3: Why is it important to speak gently to elderly individuals?

Ans: Speaking gently to the elderly is crucial because they already carry worries, and our aim should not be to add to their sorrow. Considering their limited time left, showing them love, care, and consideration is essential. Using a soft and polite tone contributes to a peaceful departure for their soul.

Q4: Why is it important to speak gently to young children?

Ans: It's important to speak gently to young children so that they can also learn the value of speaking kindly. Using a soft and gentle tone helps us build a connection with them, much like nurturing blossoming flowers.

Q5: What comparison does the poet draw between hearts and deep wells?

Ans: The poet draws a comparison between hearts and deep wells because, just as we can't see the depths of a well, we can't truly fathom what lies within a person's heart.

However, the poet is certain that kind words have a profound impact on hearts and cannot be assumed to be insincere.

Q6: What are the benefits of speaking gently, and who should we address this way according to the poem?

Ans: Speaking gently is advantageous in dealing with everyone. Love is the key to exerting influence over others. Using harsh words can taint our virtuous actions. To gain the affection of children, speaking gently is essential. Similarly, conversing gently with the elderly allows them a peaceful departure. Showing kindness and gentleness to all pleases God and promises rewards in the afterlife. As the poem says, "Gentle words unlock the iron gates."

Q7: What is meant by an anonymous poem?

Ans: An anonymous poem is one in which the poet's name is not known or disclosed.

Q8: What does the poet convey about eternity?

Ans: The poet conveys that by speaking gently to everyone, we can earn eternal rewards from God in the afterlife. This everlasting reward is easily attainable through the simple act of kindness in our interactions.